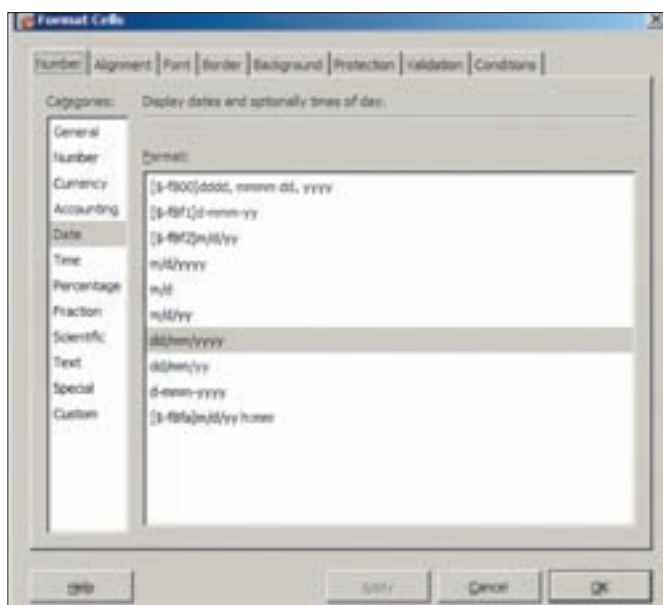




Changing the date format convention in Dnumeric

or row should be highlighted. Right-click on any cell and select format cells. Navigate to **Number>Date**, and select the dd/mm/yy convention. Now whatever date you enter in the row or column will be treated in this format. Note that this setting is applied to the selected cells only, and is not a global change.

Autosaving documents

Gnumeric has an autosave feature. However, this feature is not enabled by default. To change this setting, go to **Tools > Auto Save**. Check the "Automatically save every" checkbox. Enter the interval in minutes. Leave the "Prompt before saving" box unchecked if you don't want to be disturbed in the workflow for a save prompt every few minutes.

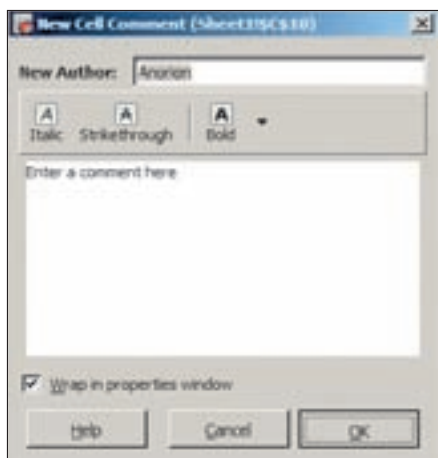
Using the clear command

The clear command is a great way to get rid of certain kinds of information from a cell, without changing others. For example, if a cell is formatted according to a particular date, then it is possible to retain the date formatting, while deleting the contents of the cell. To do this, select the cells, the row, or the column and go to **Edit > Clear > Formats**. Alternatively, you can clear

the formatting of the cell, while retaining its contents. Go to **Edit > Clear > Contents** to do this. You can also use the **Edit > Clear > Comments** to clear all the comments in a selection, or the entire sheet.

Adding a comment to a cell

To add a comment to a cell, right-click on a cell and select Edit Comments. Then type in a comment and hit [Enter]. Comments are indicated by a small red triangle in the top-right corner of a cell. To view a comment, hover the mouse pointer over this small red triangle, and a small text box should appear with the comment. Right-click on a cell



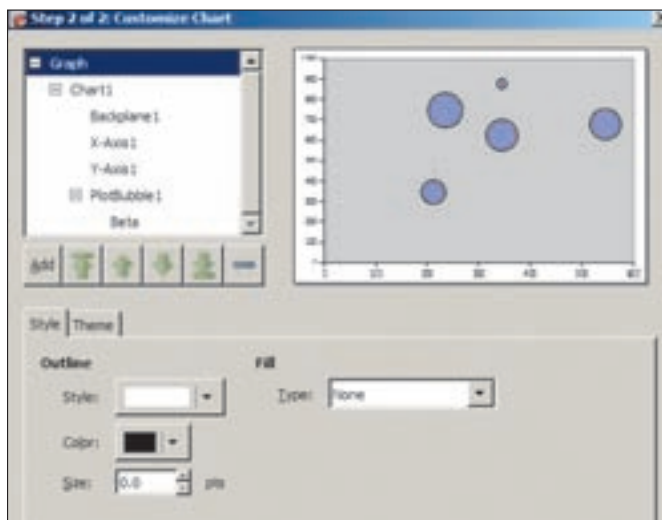
Adding a comment to a cell

with a comment, and click on Edit Comments to change the comment for that cell. Right-click on the cell and click on "Clear Comments" to delete a comment.

Using the Gnumeric format, when Gnumeric is not available

In a pinch, if you have work stored in the Gnumeric format, and want to use the contained data, but Gnumeric is not installed on the system you are working on, there is an easy way to extract the data. Gnumeric uses the .gnm extension to store files. Just change the extension to .gzip, which is a common zipping package in Linux. If you are working on a Linux system, you can do this using pre-installed

range of data that you want to be represented in the chart. Go to **Insert > Charts**, and a chart wizard should appear. The Chart wizard in Gnumeric is known as the Chart Guru. There are sixteen kinds of charts available by default – others are available using plug-ins. Select one of the chart types, and select the variables in the wizard. Once you are done configuring the Chart Guru, the chart does not immediately appear on the sheet. You have to manually click and drag the chart across the sheet, which is a welcome deviation from the norm in spreadsheet applications. This allows you to position and set the size of the chart without having to manipulate it later on. The chart is linked to the selected contents, so every time



Creating a chart in Gnumeric

tools. If, however, you are working on a Windows machine, you will need an unpacker that supports the .gzip format (peazip is a popular one). The data is extracted as an .xml file, which is compatible with many programs, and can even be opened in a text editor.

Inserting charts in a worksheet

Creating a chart in gnumeric is a simple process. After entering the data, select the

you change the data in the cells you selected to make the chart, these changes are reflected in the chart in real time.

Deleting worksheets

Sometimes it is necessary to delete worksheets. Most of the time, people use only one worksheet. However, some operations create and enter data into a new worksheet. When such operations are automated, the data is not entered into an existing blank worksheet, but instead in a new worksheet. This can clutter the work area with too many worksheets. To remove